25900436 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG3DSEHIS200 - THE ANCIENT SOCIAL FORMATIONS FROM HUNTER GATHERERS TO THE CLASSICAL ANTIQUITY

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

MCQ

Answer any **10** questions

Each question carries **1** marks

1. Who first proposed the Theory of Natural Selection? [U] / [CO1]

   a). Jean-Baptiste Lamarck b). Charles Darwin

   c). Gregor Mendel d). Alfred Wegener

2. According to 19th century anthropologists, the stages of society were: [U] / [CO1, CO2]

   a). Tribalism-Feudalism-Capitalism b). Hunting-Farming-Industrialism

   c). Nomadism-Agriculture-Urbanism d). Savagery-Barbarism-Civilization

3. Who is known as the father of Athenian Democracy? [K] / [CO2]

   a). Draco b). Solon

   c). Cleisthenes d). Pericles

4. Roman religion was primarly : [U] / [CO3, CO4]

a). Monotheistic b). Polytheistic

c). Atheistic d). Animistic

5. Imagine you are excavating a Neolithic site and find grinding stones. What activity can you infer from this evidence? [A] / [CO2, CO3]

a). Stone carving b). Metal tool sharpening

c). Construction of megaliths d). Grain processing for food preparation

6. In Mesopotamia, the Ziggurat was central because it functioned as : [K] / [CO3]

a). A Royal Palace only b). A Marketplace only

c). A Religious, Administrative and Economic Centre d). A Burial Ground for Kings

7. Agricultural surplus due to iron ploughs led to [A] / [CO3]

a). Rise of markets and trade b). Decline of food shortage

c). End of craft specialization d). Abandonment of towns

8. Platos republic is primarly concerned with what topic [K] / [CO1, CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5]

a). Ethics b). Justice and the Ideal state c). Natural Sciences d). The nature of existence

9. A Mesolithic community wanted to increase interaction with distant groups across waterways. Which innovation would directly support this? [A] / [CO2, CO3]

a). Dugout canoes with paddles b). Ground stone sickles

c). Large storage granaries d). Hand-axes

10. The earliest writing system in Mesopotamia was called : [K] / [CO4]

a). Hieroglyphs b). Cuneiform

c). Oracle bone script d). Kharosthi

11. Which ancient empire is credited with some of the earliest large scale use of iron? [A] / [CO3]

a). Hittite Empire b). Roman empire

c). Egyptian Empire d). Chinese Empire

12. Which of the following was not a major factor contributing to the Roman empires decline? [K] / [CO4]

a). Increased Military drugs from barbarian invasions

b). A thriving and stable agricultural system

c). A decline of trade and economy prospirity

d). The division of empire into Estern and Western halves

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

SHORT ANSWER

Answer any **5** questions

Each question carries **2** marks

13. Archaeologists discover grinding stones at a Mesolithic site. How would you interpret their role in subsistence practices? [A] / [CO2, CO3]

14. Explain the role of slavery in Egyptian society [U] / [CO5]

15. Evaluate the contribution of pastoral nomadism to cultural exchange and diffusion of ideas [E] / [CO2]

16. What roll did the Roman mob play in Roman society? [U] / [CO3, CO4]

17. Write a short note on the cult of Mother Goddess in Indus civilization. [U] / [CO5]

18. Briefly describe the urban drainage system in Indus valley civilization. [U] / [CO4]

19. Oiketes. [K] / [CO4]

20. What was solidus? [U] / [CO3]

[2x5 = 10]

Part C

SHORT ESSAY

Answer any **4** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

21. Analyse the role of kinship and clan systems in maintaining order in early Neolithic settlements. [An] / [CO2, CO3]

22. Why do many modern scholars favour a synthesis of diffusion and independent origin over one sided explanations on the emergence of early civilizations? [U] / [CO3]

23. Did Alexander deserve the title "The Great"? Support your view [E] / [CO2]

24. What is meant by the Augustian age and how significant is it in the course of history? [An] / [CO2]

25. Discuss the relationship between social cooperation and successful hunting strategies. [An] / [CO2, CO3]

26. How did environmental resource availability shape technological innovation in Bronze age cultures? [An] / [CO3]

27. Compare the salient features of the military systems of Sparta and Athens [An] / [CO2]

[5x4 = 20]

Part D

ESSAY QUESTION

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

28. Examine the factors that facilitated the growth of the Roman agrarian economy and analyze the causes underlying its eventual decline [I] / [CO3]

29. Explain how did the reciprocity, tolerated theft and immediate return system sustained equality in Palaeolithic groups? [An] / [CO2, CO3]

30. Evaluate the rise and development of the Shang civilization with reference to Erlitou, Erligang and Anyang [U] / [CO5]

31. Critically examine the factors that contributed to the decline and eventual failure of the Delian League [An] / [CO2]

[15x2 = 30]